

Markdown Quick Reference Card

A concise syntax guide optimized for a single two-sided printout.

1. Headers & Layout

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Heading 1	# Header 1	Main document or page title
Heading 2	## Header 2	Major section heading
Heading 3	### Header 3	Sub-section heading
Heading 4-6	#### H4 ##### H5 ##### H6	Deeply nested sub-headings
Horizontal Rule	--- or *** or ____	Creates a horizontal divider line
Line Break	End a line with two spaces and press Enter	Forces a line break without a new paragraph

2. Text Emphasis

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Bold	text or text	Bold text (strong importance)
Italic	<i>text</i> or <i>text</i>	<i>Italic text</i> (emphasis)
Bold & Italic	<i>text</i>	<i>Bold and italicized text</i>
Strikethrough	text	Strikethrough text (GFM extended)

3. Lists

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Unordered List	- Item 1 - Item 2 * Sub-item 2a	• Item 1 • Item 2 • Sub-item 2a (Indent 2 or 4 spaces)
Ordered List	1. First item 2. Second item	1. First item 2. Second item (Numbers don't have to be sequential)
Task List	- [x] Completed task - [] Incomplete task	[x] Completed task [] Incomplete task (GFM extended)

4. Links & Images

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Inline Link	[Google](https://google.com)	A hyperlink with custom descriptive text
Link with Title	[Google](https://google.com "Search")	Hovering displays the title tooltip
Anchor / ID Link	[Section 1](#section-1)	Links to an internal header anchor
Image Link	![Alt Text](image.jpg)	Embeds an image. Text shows if load fails
Linked Image	[![Alt](img.jpg)](url)	Wraps an image inside an active clickable link

5. Blocks & Code

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Blockquote	> This is a quote. > Multiple lines work.	Indents and styles block quotes from other text
Nested Blockquote	> Outer quote >> Inner nested quote	Creates a blockquote within a blockquote
Inline Code	<code>code snippet</code>	Highlights a brief phrase or command inline
Code Block	<pre>```javascript const x = 5; console.log(x); ```</pre>	Creates a multi-line code block with optional language syntax highlighting indicator

6. Tables

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Standard Table	Header 1 Header 2 --- --- Cell 1 Cell 2	Creates columns and rows using pipe and dash notation
Alignment Rules	Left Center Right :--- :---: ---: Text Text Text	Colons dictate text alignment within the column: • Left-aligned: :--- • Centered: :---: • Right-aligned: ---:

7. Miscellaneous & Extended Syntax

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Footnotes	Here is a note ^[1] . [1]: The footnote text.	Creates a small superscript link to reference notes at the bottom of the document
Escaping Characters	<code>*Not italic*</code>	Uses a backslash to render literal markdown characters
Inline HTML	<code><kbd>Ctrl</kbd></code>	Allows direct raw HTML formatting blocks inside markdown for specific elements
Emoji Shortcuts	:rocket: or :smile:	Supported on platforms like GitHub, Slack, and Discord